

A PROJECT REPORT ON

“ONLINE COMPLAINT MANAGEMENT SYSTEM”

**A Project Report in partial fulfilment of the requirement for the degree of
Bachelor of Computer Application**

Under GAUHATI UNIVERSITY



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BCA 6TH Semester (FYUGP)

ICON Commerce College

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project entitled "COLLEGE COMPLAINT MANAGEMENT SYSTEM" has been submitted by Sajib Biswas (Roll No: UT-231-049-0010, Registration No: 23084959) in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA), 6th Semester, at Icon Commerce College, Gauhati University, during the Academic Session 2025–26.

This is an authentic work carried out by him under my supervision and guidance. The project has not been submitted to any other university or institution for the award of any degree or diploma.

Date: _____

Name of the Guide: Manisha Das
Designation: Assistant Professor
Department: Bachelor of Computer Application
Institution: Icon Commerce College
Guwahati – 781021

Signature of the Guide: _____

DECLARATION

I hereby declare that the project report “Online Complaint Management System”, submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirement for the degree of Bachelor of Computer Application (BCA) in Icon Commerce College, under Gauhati University, is my original work and has not been submitted for the award of any other degree, diploma, fellowship or any other similar titles.

Date: _____

Signature: _____

Place: Guwahati

NAME: SAJIB BISWAS

ROLL NO: UT-231-049-0010

REGISTRATION NO: 23084959

DEPARTMENT: BCA 6TH SEMESTER

ICON COMMERCE COLLEGE

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

First of all, I would like to express my special thanks of gratitude to my project guide and mentor Manisha Das for instilling confidence in me and providing me with invaluable comments and criticism on many issues and constant rendering of timely advice and sparing valuable time throughout my project work.

It is my honour to thank Dr. Mandira Saha, Principal of Icon Commerce College and Tridib Kr. Handique, Co-Ordinator of B.C.A of Icon Commerce College for providing all the facilities me permission to undertake this project work. I would also like to thank the whole B.C.A department without whose help success could not have been attained.

My heartfelt gratitude goes to all those who agreed to participate in this project, for their time expended and for sharing insights and suggestions.

Finally, I would like to thank my parents and friends who helped a lot in finalizing this project within limited time frame.

Place: Guwahati

Date: _____

Name: Sajib Biswas

Roll No: UT-231-049-0012

Registration No: 23084898

BCA 6TH Semester, Icon Commerce College

ABSTRACT

The College Complaint Management System is a web-based application developed using PHP, MySQL, HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript to digitize the student grievance redressal process within a college. It replaces the traditional paper-based complaint handling method with a structured, transparent, and traceable digital platform.

The system provides two separate portals — a Student Portal and an Admin Portal — with independent session-based authentication. Students can register, log in, and submit complaints by selecting from ten predefined categories, assigning a priority level (Low, Medium, High, or Critical), and optionally attaching supporting files. Each complaint is automatically assigned a unique complaint number. Students can track the status of their complaints and view administrator responses at any time. Administrators have access to a dashboard showing live complaint statistics, tools to update complaint status through a five-stage lifecycle (Pending, In Progress, Resolved, Closed, Rejected), and a reports section with category-wise, priority-wise, and monthly analytics.

Security is ensured through bcrypt password hashing, PHP session management, and SQL injection prevention via MySQLi prepared statements. The system is deployable on any standard Apache server environment such as XAMPP or WAMP.

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Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

In an educational institution, students frequently face various issues — related to academics, infrastructure, hostel facilities, library resources, transportation, canteen services, and administrative procedures. Traditionally, such concerns are communicated informally, either through verbal discussion with teachers or by submitting handwritten complaint letters. This manual process is inefficient, untraceable, and often results in complaints being lost or unresolved.

With the widespread adoption of web-based technologies, it has become practical to digitize this process. A web-based complaint management system provides a centralized, transparent, and traceable platform where students can formally register their grievances and administrators can track, respond to, and resolve them systematically.

1.2 Problem Statement

The absence of a structured complaint mechanism in colleges leads to several issues:

- Complaints submitted verbally or on paper are easily misplaced and forgotten.
- Students have no way to track what happened to their complaint after submission.
- Administrators have no consolidated view of pending or recurring issues.
- There is no priority-based handling of urgent complaints.
- There is no permanent audit record of complaints and their resolutions.

1.3 Proposed Solution

The College Complaint Management System is a web-based application developed using PHP and MySQL. It provides a structured portal where students can register, log in, and submit complaints with a subject, description, category, and priority level. Each complaint is assigned a unique identifier. Administrators log into a separate panel, where they can view all complaints, respond to them, update their status, and view statistics through a dashboard. The system ensures transparency, traceability, and efficiency in the college grievance redressal process.

Chapter 2

REQUIREMENT SPECIFICATION

2.1 System Requirements

Hardware Requirements

Component	Minimum Specification
Processor	Intel Core i3 or equivalent
RAM	4 GB or higher
Storage	20 GB available disk space
Network	Internet connection for hosting / local network for LAN

2.2 Technologies Used

The following technologies were identified directly from the project source files. No external framework or technology beyond these was used.

Technology	Version / Detail	Role in Project
PHP	7.4+	Server-side scripting — handles all form processing, session management, database interaction, file uploads, and authentication logic.
MySQL	5.7+	Relational database — stores all data: users, admins, categories, complaints, and responses.
mysqli (PHP Extension)	—	Used for database connectivity, prepared statements, and parameterized queries to prevent SQL injection.
HTML5	—	Provides the structure of all web pages — login, registration, complaint forms, dashboards.
CSS3	—	Provides all visual styling via style.css — responsive layout, sidebar, cards, badges, forms.
JavaScript (Vanilla)	—	Client-side logic in main.js — form validation, modal control, file preview, table search/filter, CSV export, sidebar toggle, character counter, tooltip system.
Font Awesome	6.4.0 (CDN)	Icon library used throughout the interface — navigation icons, stat card icons, button icons.
Apache Web Server	XAMPP/WAMP	Local server environment for running PHP and serving the web application.
Session Management	PHP Sessions	Used to maintain authenticated state for both students and administrators across pages.

- PHP — Server-side scripting for form handling, session management, and database operations
- MySQL — Relational database management system for storing users, complaints, categories, and responses
- mysqli extension — PHP extension used for database connectivity and query execution
- HTML5 / CSS3 — Structure and styling of the web interface
- JavaScript — Client-side validation, dynamic UI interactions, and file preview
- Font Awesome 6.4.0 — Icon library loaded via CDN for UI icons throughout the application
- Session Management — PHP sessions used to authenticate and maintain logged-in state for both students and admins

Chapter 3

OBJECT OF THE PROJECT

The primary objectives of the College Complaint Management System are:

1. To provide students with a dedicated online portal to register and track complaints without needing to visit the administration office in person.
2. To enable college administrators to view, manage, respond to, and resolve all student complaints through a centralized dashboard.
3. To categorize complaints across 10 predefined areas — Academic, Infrastructure, Library, Hostel, Transport, Canteen, Administration, IT Services, Harassment, and Other — for organized handling.
4. To implement a four-level priority classification (Low, Medium, High, Critical) that helps administrators identify and address urgent issues first.
5. To track complaints through a well-defined five-stage lifecycle: Pending → In Progress → Resolved → Closed / Rejected.
6. To allow students to attach supporting documents or images (JPG, PNG, PDF, DOC, DOCX) to their complaints.
7. To auto-generate a unique complaint number for each submission, enabling easy reference and tracking.
8. To provide statistical reports to administrators, including category-wise, priority-wise, and monthly complaint trends.
9. To ensure system security through password hashing, session-based authentication, and SQL injection prevention via prepared statements.
10. To allow students to update their profile information and change their password within the portal.

Chapter 4

SCOPE OF THE PROJECT

The College Complaint Management System is scoped to serve the internal grievance management needs of a single college institution. The system serves two types of users — students and administrators — through separate, secure portals.

4.1 What is In Scope:

- Student registration and login with secure password hashing.
- Submission of complaints across 10 defined categories with subject, description, priority, and optional file attachment.
- Unique complaint number generation upon each submission.
- Student ability to view all their submitted complaints and their current status.
- Student ability to view admin responses against their complaints.
- Student profile management — update personal details and change password.
- Admin login with session-based authentication.
- Admin dashboard with real-time statistics (total, pending, in progress, resolved complaints; total registered students).
- Admin ability to view all complaints, update status, and add responses.
- Admin management of student records and complaint categories.
- Admin reports section with category-wise, priority-wise, and monthly statistics.
- Print report functionality on the admin reports page.

4.2 What is Out of Scope:

- The system does not currently send automated email or SMS notifications (the function exists as a placeholder in the codebase but is not active).
- The system does not support multiple college institutions or departments as separate administrative units.
- No mobile application exists — the system is browser-based only.
- No role-based admin hierarchy — all admins have the same level of access.
- No real-time chat feature is implemented.

Chapter 5

SYSTEM ANALYSIS

5.1 Existing System

In most colleges, student complaints are currently handled through one or more of the following informal methods:

- Students verbally report issues to teachers, HODs, or office staff.
- Students submit handwritten complaint letters which are manually handled.
- Complaints via email are sent without any standardized format or tracking mechanism.

These approaches have clear shortcomings — complaints can easily be forgotten, there is no transparency for the student, there is no formal record maintained, and recurring issues cannot be identified from aggregate data.

5.2 Proposed System

The proposed College Complaint Management System replaces the informal process with a structured web-based platform. Key improvements over the existing approach include:

- All complaints are stored digitally in a MySQL database with a permanent audit trail.
- Students can submit and track complaints 24/7 from any device with a browser.
- Every complaint is given a unique auto-generated complaint number.
- Priority classification ensures critical issues are visible and handled first.
- Admins can respond to complaints in-system, and the response is visible to the student.
- A reports section gives administrators aggregate data to identify problem areas.

5.3 Feasibility Study

Technical Feasibility

The system is built using well-established and freely available technologies — PHP, MySQL, HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript — that can be hosted on any standard Apache/XAMPP/WAMP server. No proprietary software or special hardware is required, making it technically feasible for any college with a basic server setup.

Economic Feasibility

All technologies used (PHP, MySQL, Apache) are open-source and free of cost. The system requires only a standard shared or local server, resulting in minimal operational cost. This makes the system highly economically feasible for educational institutions.

Operational Feasibility

The system is designed with a clean, intuitive interface for both students and administrators. Students with basic computer literacy can easily register, log in, and submit complaints. Administrators can manage complaints without any specialized technical training, making the system fully operationally feasible.

Chapter 6

SYSTEM DESIGN

6.1 System Architecture

The system follows a three-tier client-server architecture: a Presentation Layer (HTML/CSS/JavaScript in the browser), an Application Layer (PHP running on Apache), and a Data Layer (MySQL database). The student and admin portals share the same database but use independent authentication mechanisms.

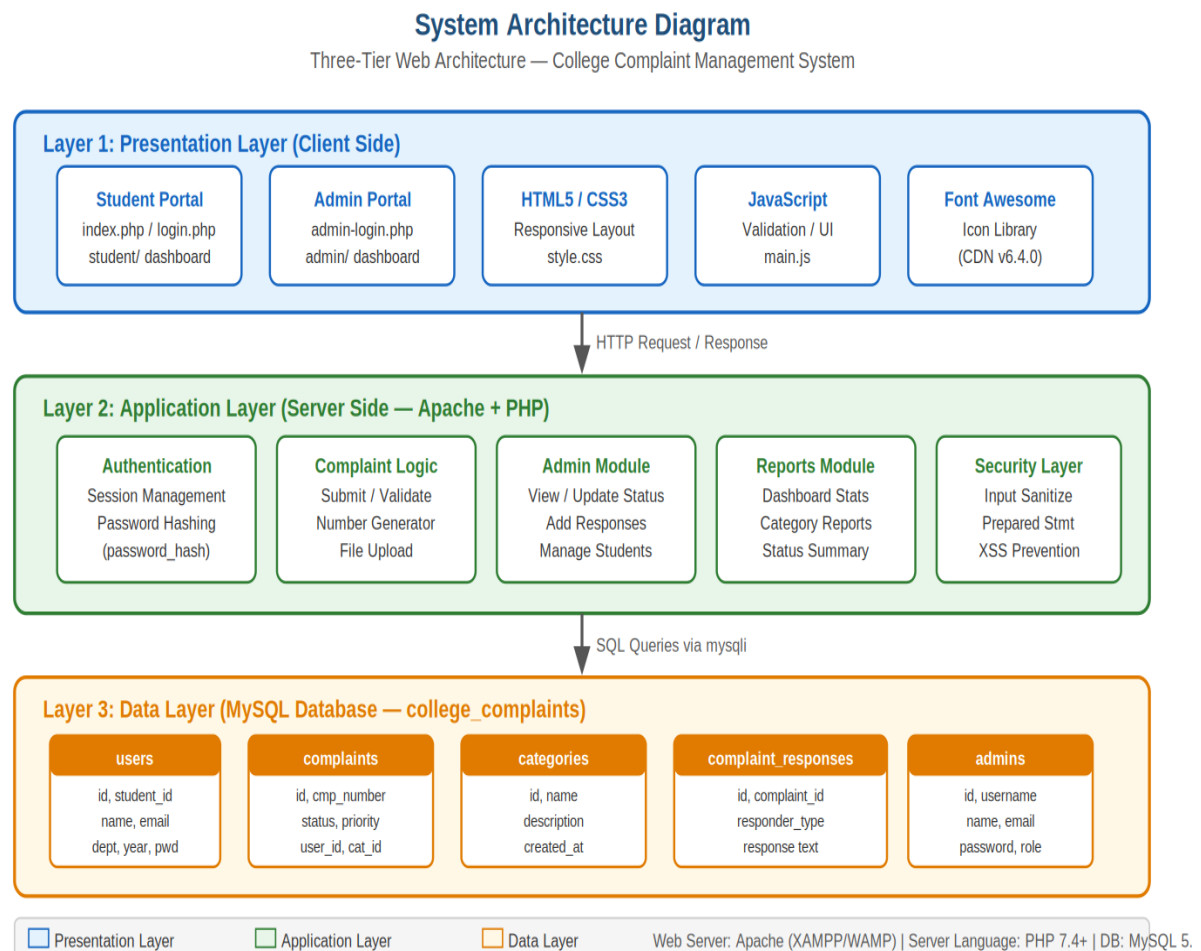


Figure 6.1 — System Architecture Diagram

6.2 Data Flow Diagram — Level 0 (Context Diagram)

The Level 0 DFD represents the system as a single process with two external entities — the Student and the Administrator — showing the high-level flow of data in and out of the system.

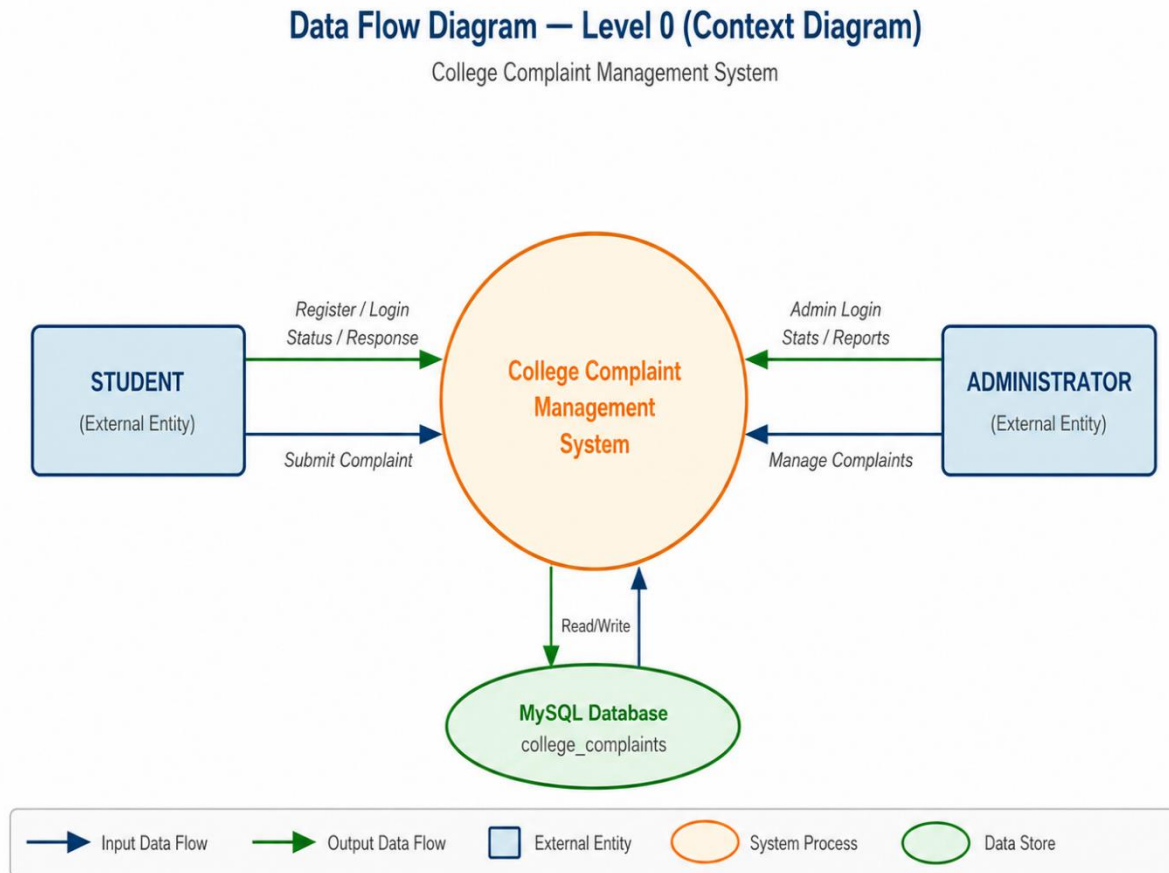


Figure 6.2 — DFD Level 0: Context Diagram

6.3 Data Flow Diagram — Level 1 (Detailed)

The Level 1 DFD breaks the system into six major processes: Student Registration/Login, Complaint Submission, Complaint Tracking, Admin Dashboard, Complaint Management, and Report Generation — each connected to the relevant data stores.

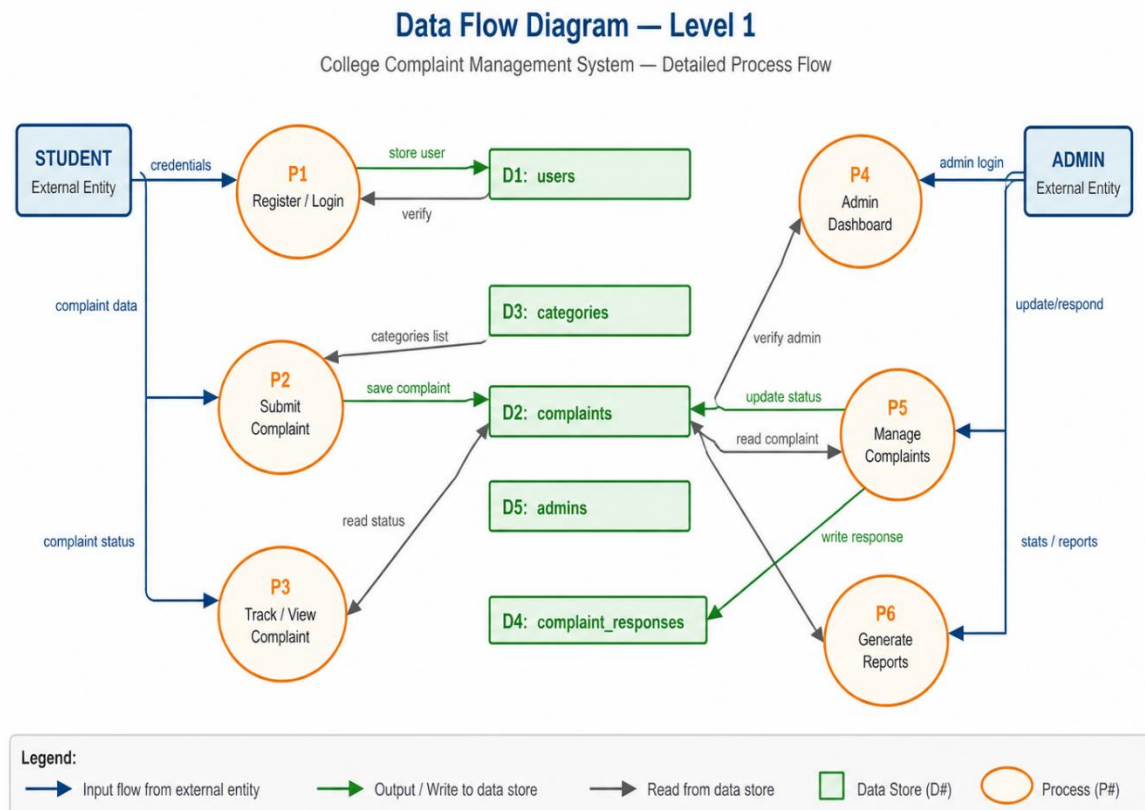


Figure 6.3 — DFD Level 1: Detailed Process Flow

6.4 Use Case Diagram

The Use Case Diagram shows all the actions available to each actor (Student and Administrator) and the boundary of the system.

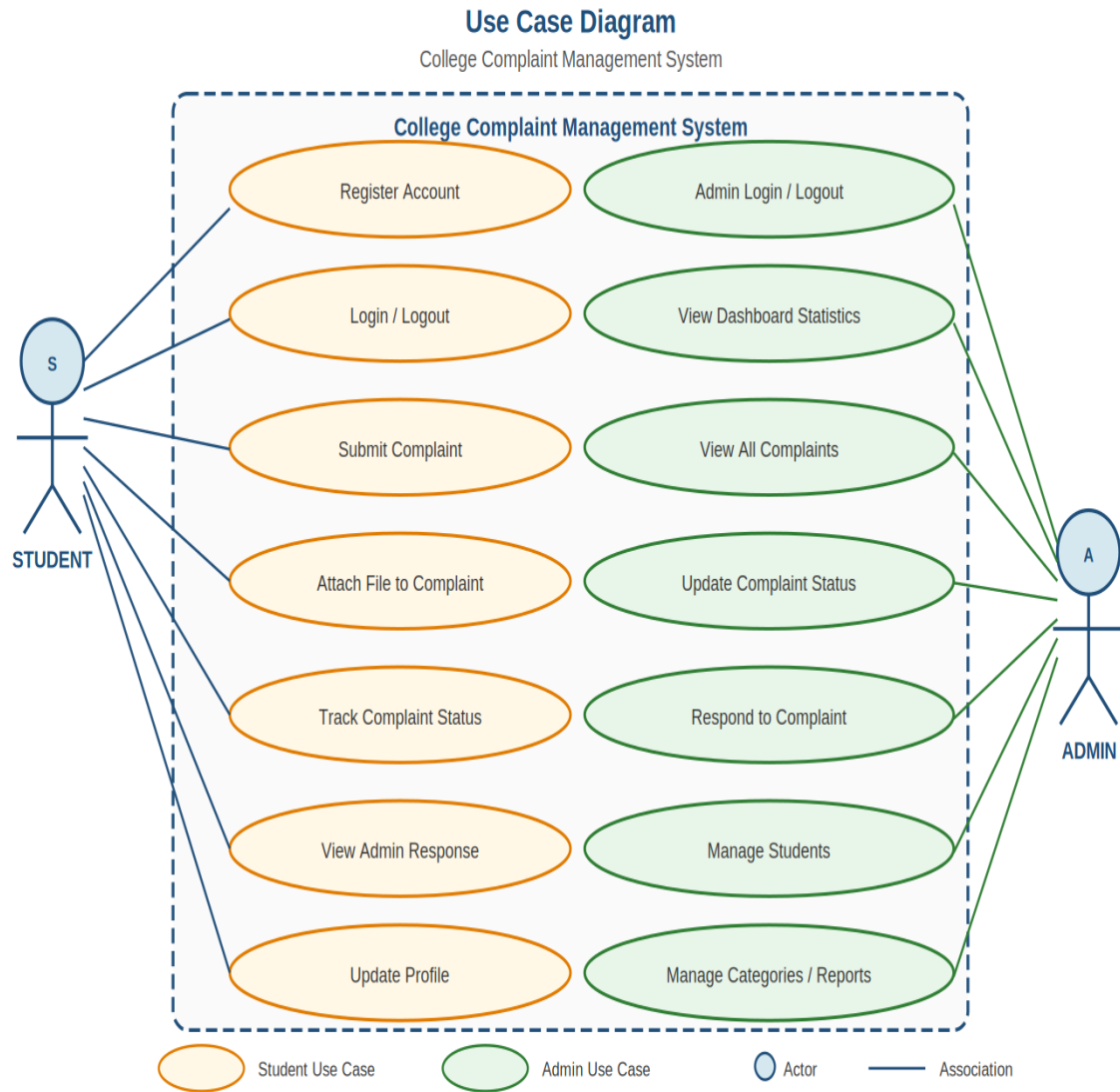
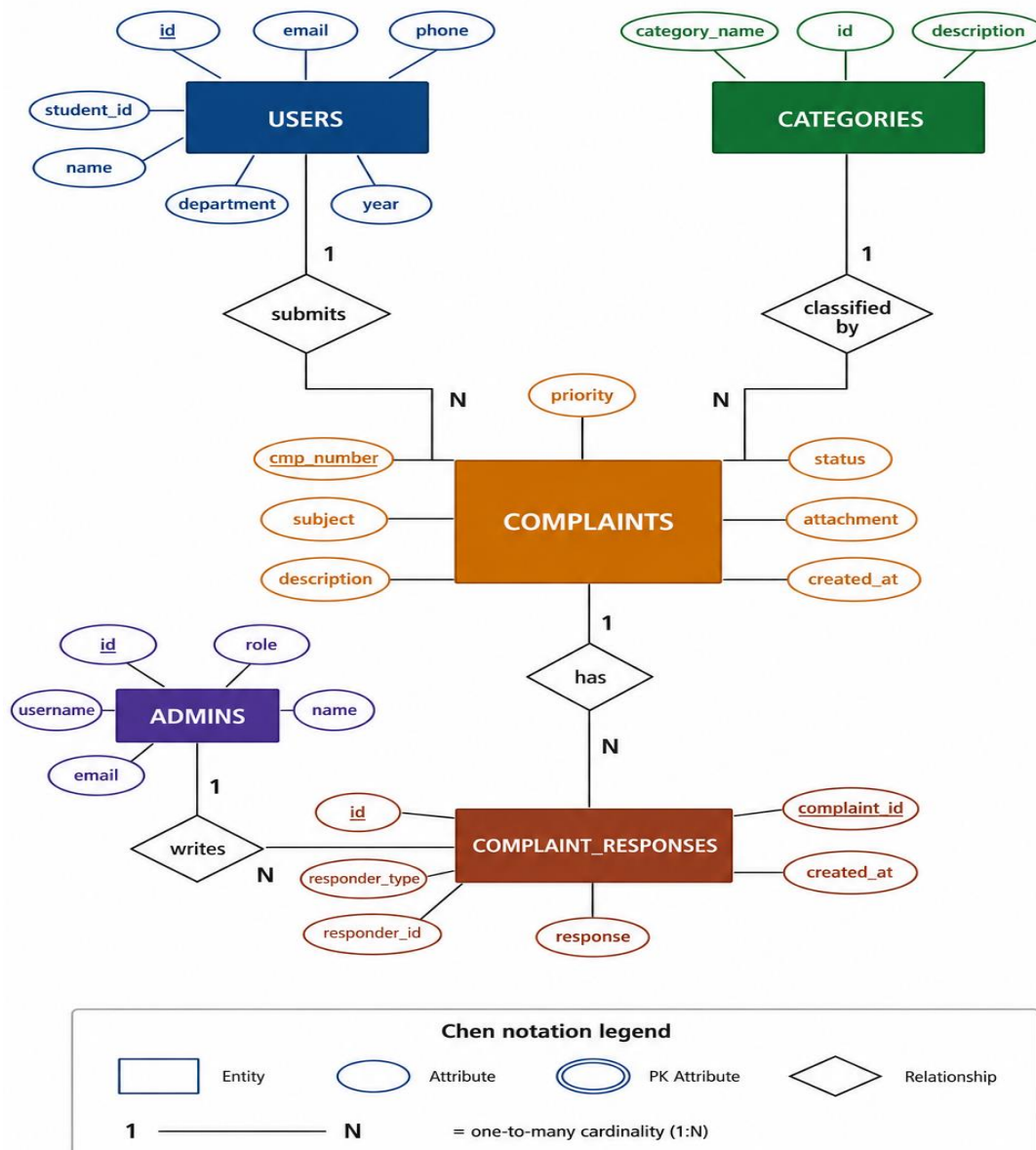


Figure 6.4 — Use Case Diagram

5.5 Entity-Relationship (ER) Diagram

The ER Diagram shows the five database entities and their relationships. COMPLAINTS is the central entity, linked to USERS and CATEGORIES through foreign keys, and to COMPLAINT_RESPONSES through a one-to-many relationship.

Figure 6.5 — Entity-Relationship (ER) Diagram



Chapter 7

DATABASE DESIGN

DATABASE DESIGN

The database is named college_complaints and consists of five tables. All tables are in MySQL with proper data types, primary keys, and foreign key relationships.

Table 1: users

Field Name	Data Type	Constraint	Description
id	INT	PK, AUTO_INCREMENT	Unique student record ID
student_id	VARCHAR(50)	UNIQUE, NOT NULL	College-assigned student ID
name	VARCHAR(100)	NOT NULL	Full name of the student
email	VARCHAR(100)	UNIQUE, NOT NULL	Email address (used for login)
phone	VARCHAR(20)	NULL	Contact phone number
department	VARCHAR(100)	NULL	Student's department
year	VARCHAR(20)	NULL	Year of study
password	VARCHAR(255)	NOT NULL	Bcrypt-hashed password
created_at	TIMESTAMP	DEFAULT NOW()	Registration timestamp

Table 2: admins

Field Name	Data Type	Constraint	Description
id	INT	PK, AUTO_INCREMENT	Unique admin record ID
username	VARCHAR(50)	UNIQUE, NOT NULL	Admin username for login
name	VARCHAR(100)	NOT NULL	Full name of administrator
email	VARCHAR(100)	UNIQUE, NOT NULL	Admin email address
password	VARCHAR(255)	NOT NULL	Bcrypt-hashed password
role	VARCHAR(50)	DEFAULT 'admin'	Admin role identifier
created_at	TIMESTAMP	DEFAULT NOW()	Account creation timestamp

Table 3: categories

Field Name	Data Type	Constraint	Description
id	INT	PK, AUTO_INCREMENT	Unique category ID
category_name	VARCHAR(100)	NOT NULL	Name of the complaint category
description	TEXT	NULL	Description of the category
created_at	TIMESTAMP	DEFAULT NOW()	Creation timestamp

Default categories pre-loaded: Academic, Infrastructure, Library, Hostel, Transport, Canteen, Administration, IT Services, Harassment, Other.

Table 4: complaints

Field Name	Data Type	Constraint	Description
id	INT	PK, AUTO_INCREMENT	Unique complaint ID
complaint_number	VARCHAR(50)	UNIQUE, NOT NULL	Auto-generated (CMP+date+rand)
user_id	INT	FK → users(id)	Student who submitted the complaint
category_id	INT	FK → categories(id)	Complaint category
subject	VARCHAR(255)	NOT NULL	Brief subject of the complaint
description	TEXT	NOT NULL	Detailed description
priority	ENUM	Default 'Medium'	Low / Medium / High / Critical
status	ENUM	Default 'Pending'	Pending/In Progress/Resolved/Closed/Rejected
attachment	VARCHAR(255)	NULL	Filename of uploaded attachment
created_at	TIMESTAMP	DEFAULT NOW()	Submission timestamp
updated_at	TIMESTAMP	ON UPDATE NOW()	Last modification timestamp
resolved_at	TIMESTAMP	NULL	Timestamp when resolved

Table 5: complaint_responses

Field Name	Data Type	Constraint	Description
id	INT	PK, AUTO_INCREMENT	Unique response ID
complaint_id	INT	FK → complaints(id)	The complaint being responded to
responder_type	ENUM	NOT NULL	'admin' or 'student'
responder_id	INT	NOT NULL	ID of the admin or student responding
response	TEXT	NOT NULL	The response message text
created_at	TIMESTAMP	DEFAULT NOW()	Response timestamp

Chapter 8

IMPLEMENTATION/WORKING

IMPLEMENTATION / WORKING

This chapter explains the step-by-step working of the system as it operates in practice. The system is divided into a Student Portal and an Admin Portal.

8.1 Home Page (home.php)

The home page serves as a public landing page. It contains a navigation bar with links to the Student Login and Registration pages. It also displays a hero section describing the system, a features overview, and a how-it-works section. This page does not require authentication.

8.2 Student Registration (register.php)

A new student fills in a registration form with their Student ID, full name, email address, phone number, department, year of study, password, and confirm password. The system validates that all required fields are present, the passwords match, the password is at least 6 characters long, and the Student ID and email are not already registered. On success, the password is hashed using PHP's `password_hash()` and stored in the users table.

8.3 Student Login (index.php)

A registered student logs in using their email and password. The system uses a prepared statement to retrieve the user record by email, then verifies the submitted password against the stored hash using `password_verify()`. On success, a PHP session is created with `user_id`, `user_name`, `user_email`, and `student_id`. The student is then redirected to the Student Dashboard.

8.4 Student Dashboard (student/dashboard.php)

The student dashboard displays four statistics cards: Total Complaints, Pending, In Progress, and Resolved — all queried live from the complaints table filtered by the logged-in student's `user_id`. Below the stats, a table shows the 10 most recent complaints with their category, subject, priority, status, and date. Each complaint has a View button leading to its detail page.

8.5 Submit Complaint (student/new-complaint.php)

The student selects a complaint category from a dropdown (populated from the categories table), fills in a subject and description, selects a priority level (Low/Medium/High/Critical), and optionally uploads a file. Allowed file types are JPG, JPEG, PNG, PDF, DOC, and DOCX. The system uses the `uploadFile()` helper function (from `functions.php`) to validate and store the file in the `/uploads/` directory using `uniqid()` as the filename. A unique complaint number is generated via `generateComplaintNumber()` in the format `CMP + YYYYMMDD + 4 random digits`. The complaint is then inserted into the complaints table via a prepared statement.

8.6 My Complaints (student/my-complaints.php)

This page lists all complaints submitted by the logged-in student, joined with the categories table to show the category name. Students can see the complaint number, category, subject, priority, status, and submission date, and can click any complaint to view its full detail and admin response.

8.7 View Complaint (student/view-complaint.php)

This page shows the full details of a specific complaint — including description, attachment (with a download link if present), current status, and all admin responses loaded from the `complaint_responses` table. Students can also add their own response from this page.

8.8 Student Profile (student/profile.php)

Students can view and update their profile details (name, phone, department, year). The email and student ID fields are read-only. Students can also change their password from this page — the current password is verified using `password_verify()` before the new password is hashed and saved.

8.9 Admin Login (admin-login.php)

Admins log in with a username and password. The system queries the admins table using a prepared statement and verifies the password with `password_verify()`. On success, an admin session is created and the admin is redirected to the Admin Dashboard.

8.10 Admin Dashboard (admin/dashboard.php)

The admin dashboard displays five statistics: Total Complaints, Pending, In Progress, Resolved (all from the complaints table), and Total Students (from the users table). A recent complaints table shows the last 10 complaints across all students, joined with users and categories tables.

8.11 All Complaints (admin/all-complaints.php)

This page lists all complaints from all students with search and status-filter functionality implemented in JavaScript (searchTable() and filterByStatus() functions from main.js). Each row has a View/Manage button.

8.12 View / Manage Complaint (admin/view-complaint.php)

The admin sees full complaint details including the student's name, email, student ID, and phone. The admin can update the complaint status from a dropdown (Pending, In Progress, Resolved, Closed, Rejected) via an UPDATE prepared statement. The admin can also add a response, which is inserted into the complaint_responses table with responder_type = 'admin'.

8.13 Manage Students (admin/manage-students.php)

This page displays a list of all registered students retrieved from the users table, showing student ID, name, email, department, year, and registration date.

8.14 Categories (admin/categories.php)

Admins can view the list of all complaint categories from the categories table. The page also allows adding new categories with a name and description.

8.15 Reports (admin/reports.php)

The reports page queries and displays: overall statistics (total, pending, resolved, in progress, closed, rejected), category-wise complaint counts (using a LEFT JOIN between categories and complaints, grouped by category), priority-wise counts (grouped by priority field), and monthly complaint counts for the last 6 months. A Print Report button uses window.print() via JavaScript.

8.16 Security Implementation

Security is implemented at multiple levels: password hashing using PHP's `password_hash()` with `PASSWORD_DEFAULT` (bcrypt), password verification using `password_verify()`, SQL injection prevention through MySQLi prepared statements with `bind_param()` across all database queries, input sanitization using the `sanitize()` function (`trim`, `stripslashes`, `htmlspecialchars`, `mysqli_real_escape_string`), and session-based access control using `requireLogin()` and `requireAdminLogin()` functions at the top of every protected page.

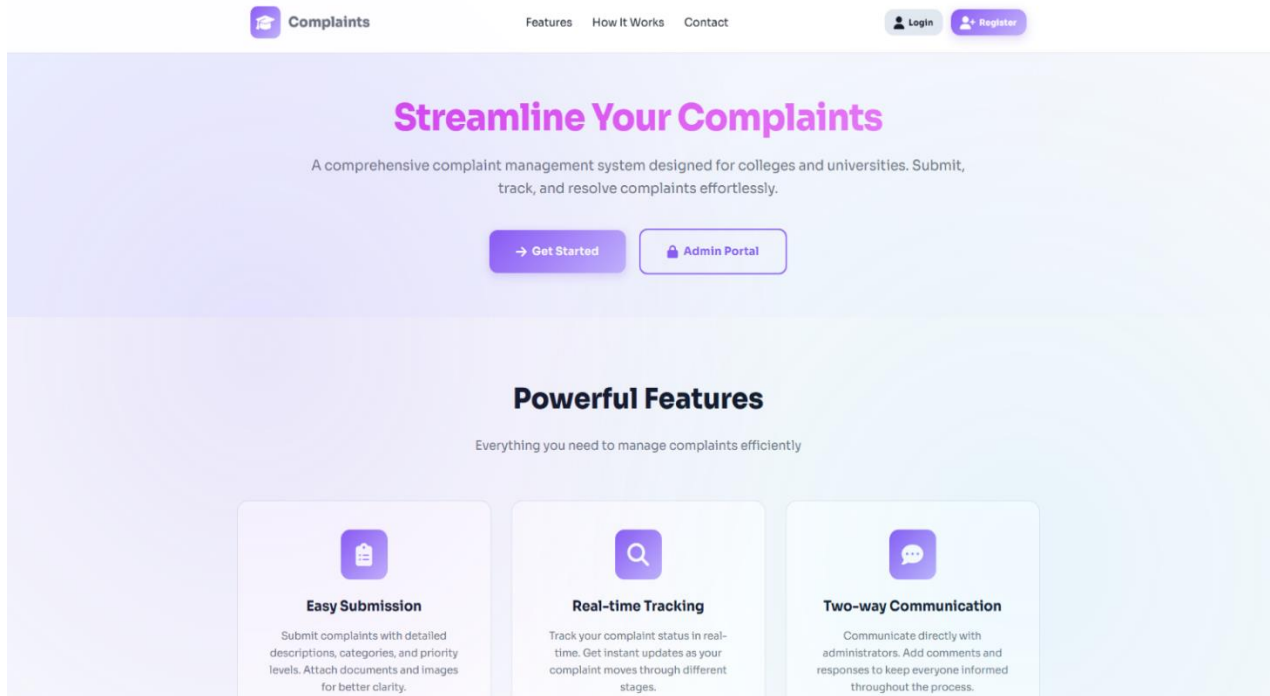
Chapter 9

SAMPLE SCREENSHOTS

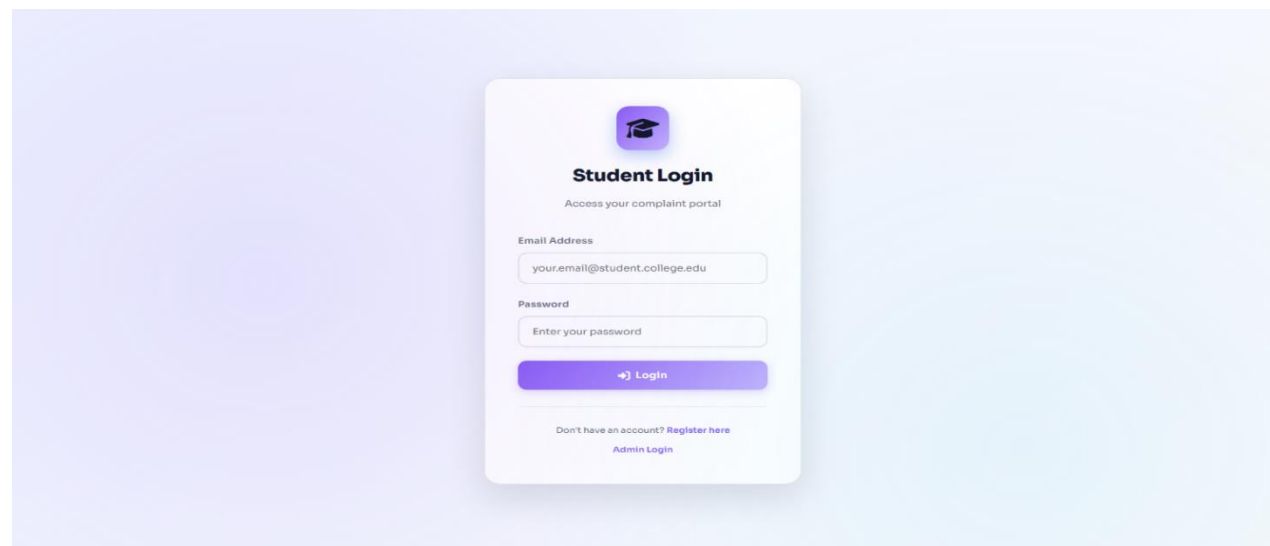
The following screenshots illustrate the key pages and functionalities of the College Complaint Management System. Please insert the actual screenshots at the indicated positions before final submission.

10.1 Public Pages

HOME-PAGE



STUDENT LOGIN-PAGE



STUDENT REGISTRATION-PAGE

Student Registration

Create your account to submit complaints

Student ID *
e.g., STU2024001

Full Name *
Enter your full name

Email Address *
your.email@student.college.edu

Phone Number
Enter your phone number

Department
Select Department

Year
Select Year

10.2 STUDENT PORTAL

STUDENT DASHBOARD

CMS
Complaint System

Welcome back,
Sajib Biswas

[Dashboard](#)
[New Complaint](#)
[My Complaints](#)
[My Profile](#)
[Logout](#)

Dashboard

[+ New Complaint](#)

TOTAL COMPLAINTS
1

PENDING
0

IN PROGRESS
0

RESOLVED
1

Recent Complaints

View All

COMPLAINT #	SUBJECT	CATEGORY	PRIORITY	STATUS	DATE	ACTION
CMP202604303107	Exam result	Academic	HIGH	RESOLVED	Apr 30, 2026	View

SUBMIT NEW COMPLAINT

**CMS**
Complaint System

Welcome back,
Sajib Biswas

[Dashboard](#)
[New Complaint](#)
[My Complaints](#)
[My Profile](#)
[Logout](#)

Submit New Complaint

[My Complaints](#)

Complaint Details

Category *
Select Category

Priority *
Medium

Subject *
Brief description of your complaint

Detailed Description *
Provide detailed information about your complaint...

Please provide as much detail as possible to help us resolve your complaint efficiently.

Attachment (Optional)
Choose file (Max 5MB)

Allowed formats: JPG, PNG, PDF, DOC, DOCX

MY COMPLAINT LIST

**CMS**
Complaint System

Welcome back,
Sajib Biswas

[Dashboard](#)
[New Complaint](#)
[My Complaints](#)
[My Profile](#)
[Logout](#)

My Complaints

[+ New Complaint](#)

All Your Complaints

Search complaints...[All Status](#)

COMPLAINT #	SUBJECT	CATEGORY	PRIORITY	STATUS	SUBMITTED ON	LAST UPDATED	ACTION
CMP202604303107	Exam result	Academic	HIGH	RESOLVED	Apr 30, 2026	Apr 30, 2026	View

VIEW COMPLAINT

**CMS**
Complaint System

Welcome back,
Sajib Biswas

[Dashboard](#)
[New Complaint](#)
[My Complaints](#)
[My Profile](#)
[Logout](#)

Complaint #CMP202604303107
Submitted on Apr 30, 2026 11:29 AM

HIGH

RESOLVED

Category
Academic

Subject
Exam result

Description
iufinb

Attachment
[Download Attachment](#)

Last Updated
Apr 30, 2026 11:31 AM

Communication History

No responses yet. Admins will respond to your complaint soon.

Add a Comment

STUDENT PROFILE-PAGE

**CMS**
Complaint System

Welcome back,
Sajib Biswas

[Dashboard](#)
[New Complaint](#)
[My Complaints](#)
[My Profile](#)
[Logout](#)

My Profile

Profile Information

Student ID
UT-231-049-0010

Full Name *
Sajib Biswas

Email Address
sajib@college.edu

Phone Number
1234567898

Department
Computer Science

Year
3rd Year

[Update Profile](#)

10.3 ADMIN PORTAL

ADMIN LOGIN-PAGE



Admin Login

Manage college complaints

Username or Email

Password

[Login as Admin](#)

[Back to Student Login](#)

ADMIN DASHBOARD

**Admin Panel**
Complaint System

Logged in as
System Administrator

[Dashboard](#)

[All Complaints](#)

[Manage Students](#)

[Categories](#)

[Reports](#)

[Logout](#)

Admin Dashboard

Tuesday, May 5, 2026

TOTAL COMPLAINTS
3

PENDING
1

IN PROGRESS
1

RESOLVED
1

TOTAL STUDENTS
3

Recent Complaints

View All

COMPLAINT #	STUDENT	SUBJECT	CATEGORY	PRIORITY	STATUS	DATE	ACTION
CMP202604303107	Sajib Biswas UT-231-049-0010	Exam result	Academic	HIGH	RESOLVED	Apr 30, 2026	View
CMP202604283680	Roshan Dey UT-231-049-0008	Poor Food Quality and Hygiene in Cafeteria	Canteen	MEDIUM	IN PROGRESS	Apr 28, 2026	View
CMP202604286112	Abhiraj Rabha UT-231-049-0003	Unfair Grading on Midterm Exam	Academic	HIGH	PENDING	Apr 28, 2026	View

ALL COMPLAINT PAGE

**Admin Panel**
Complaint System

Logged in as,
System Administrator

Dashboard

All Complaints

Manage Students

Categories

Reports

Logout

All Complaints

Complaint Management

Search complaints... All Status

COMPLAINT #	STUDENT	SUBJECT	CATEGORY	PRIORITY	STATUS	DATE	ACTION
CMP202604303107	Sajib Biswas UT-231-049-0010	Exam result	Academic	HIGH	RESOLVED	Apr 30, 2026	Manage
CMP202604283680	Roshan Dey UT-231-049-0008	Poor Food Quality and Hygiene in Cafeteria	Canteen	MEDIUM	IN PROGRESS	Apr 28, 2026	Manage
CMP202604286112	Abhiraj Rabha UT-231-049-0003	Unfair Grading on Midterm Exam	Academic	HIGH	PENDING	Apr 28, 2026	Manage

MANAGE COMPLAINT PAGE

**Admin Panel**
Complaint System

Logged in as,
System Administrator

Dashboard

All Complaints

Manage Students

Categories

Reports

Logout

Manage Complaint

[← Back to List](#)

Complaint #CMP202604303107

Submitted on Apr 30, 2026 11:29 AM

Category

Academic

Last Updated

Apr 30, 2026 11:31 AM

Subject

Exam result

Description

iufinb

Attachment

[Download Attachment](#)

Student Information

Name

Sajib Biswas

Student ID

UT-231-049-0010

Email

sajib@college.edu

Phone

1234567898

Update Status

Change Status

Resolved

[✓ Update Status](#)

Communication History

No responses yet.

Add Response

MANAGE STUDENT PAGE

 **Admin Panel**
Complaint System

Logged in as,
System Administrator

Dashboard

All Complaints

Manage Students

Categories

Reports

Logout

Manage Students

Registered Students

Search students...

STUDENT ID	NAME	EMAIL	PHONE	DEPARTMENT	YEAR	TOTAL COMPLAINTS	REGISTERED ON
UT-231-049-0010	Sajib Biswas	sajib@college.edu	1234567898	Computer Science	3rd Year	1	Apr 30, 2026
UT-231-049-0008	Roshan Dey	roshan08@college.edu	1234567898	Computer Science	3rd Year	1	Apr 28, 2026
UT-231-049-0003	Abhiraj Rabha	abhiraj03@college.edu	1234567890	Computer Science	3rd Year	1	Mar 16, 2026

CATEGORIES PAGE

 **Admin Panel**
Complaint System

Logged in as,
System Administrator

Dashboard

All Complaints

Manage Students

Categories

Reports

Logout

Manage Categories

+ Add Category

Complaint Categories

ID	CATEGORY NAME	DESCRIPTION	TOTAL COMPLAINTS	CREATED ON	ACTION
1	Academic	Issues related to academics, courses, exams	2	Feb 21, 2026	 Delete
7	Administration	Administrative procedures and documentation	0	Feb 21, 2026	 Delete
6	Canteen	Food and canteen services	1	Feb 21, 2026	 Delete
9	Harassment	Any form of harassment or discrimination	0	Feb 21, 2026	 Delete
4	Hostel	Hostel accommodation and facilities	0	Feb 21, 2026	 Delete
2	Infrastructure	Building, classroom, lab facilities	0	Feb 21, 2026	 Delete
8	IT Services	Internet, computer labs, software	0	Feb 21, 2026	 Delete
3	Library	Library services and resources	0	Feb 21, 2026	 Delete
10	Other	Other complaints	0	Feb 21, 2026	 Delete

REPORTS PAGE

Admin Panel

Complaint System

Logged in as,
System Administrator

Dashboard

All Complaints

Manage Students

Categories

Reports

Logout

Reports & Analytics

Print Report

TOTAL COMPLAINTS

3

TOTAL STUDENTS

3

Status Distribution

STATUS	COUNT	PERCENTAGE
PENDING	1	33.3%
IN PROGRESS	1	33.3%
RESOLVED	1	33.3%
CLOSED	0	0.0%
REJECTED	0	0.0%

Category-wise Complaints

Priority Distribution

Chapter 10

ADVANTAGE AND LIMITATION

10.1 Advantages

- **Centralized Record-Keeping:** All complaints are stored in a MySQL database with timestamps, providing a permanent and searchable record.
- **Transparency:** Students can log in at any time to check the current status of their complaint and read administrator responses, eliminating uncertainty.
- **Unique Complaint Tracking:** Every complaint receives an auto-generated unique number (e.g., CMP202601150482), enabling easy reference in follow-up communication.
- **Priority-Based Handling:** The four-level priority system (Low, Medium, High, Critical) ensures administrators can identify and act on the most urgent complaints first.
- **File Attachment Support:** Students can attach photos or documents (JPG, PNG, PDF, DOC, DOCX) as evidence, making complaints more informative and verifiable.
- **Administrative Reports:** The reports module gives administrators aggregated data by status, category, priority, and month, enabling data-driven decisions.
- **Secure System:** Password hashing (bcrypt), prepared statements, and input sanitization make the system resistant to common web vulnerabilities.
- **User-Friendly Interface:** The system has a clean, consistent, and responsive interface that does not require specialized technical training to use.
- **Admin Response Mechanism:** Administrators can directly respond to complaints within the system, creating a documented two-way communication thread.

10.2 Limitations

- **No Automated Email Notifications:** The `sendEmailNotification()` function is present in the code but is implemented as a placeholder (returns true without sending). Students are not notified by email when their complaint status changes.
- **Browser-Based Only:** The system has no companion mobile application. Students and admins must use a web browser to access the portal.
- **No Real-Time Updates:** The complaint status does not update in real time — the student must manually refresh or revisit the page to see changes.
- **Flat Admin Role:** All administrators have identical access. There is no department-wise routing or multi-level admin hierarchy.
- **Single Institution:** The system is designed for a single college. It does not support multi-branch or multi-campus configurations.
- **5 MB File Limit:** The `uploadFile()` function does not enforce a file size limit in the code, but practical server configuration typically limits uploads to 5 MB.
- **No CSV Export in All Sections:** CSV export (`exportToCSV` function in `main.js`) is implemented in JavaScript but may not be wired to all complaint listing tables.

Chapter 11

FUTURE ENHANCEMENTS

The following enhancements are realistic and directly tied to the current state of the project codebase:

1. **Activate Email Notifications:** The `sendEmailNotification()` function already exists in `functions.php` but is commented out. Integrating PHPMailer or SMTP configuration would enable automated email alerts to students whenever their complaint status changes or when the admin posts a response.
2. **SMS Alerts:** Integrate an SMS gateway (such as Twilio or Fast2SMS) to send text message updates to students' registered phone numbers, which are already stored in the `users` table.
3. **Department-Wise Admin Routing:** Introduce an additional role field or department assignment for admins so that complaints are automatically routed to the relevant department's administrator based on the complaint category.
4. **Real-Time Complaint Status:** Implement AJAX-based polling or WebSocket communication so that complaint status updates appear for the student without requiring a full page refresh.
5. **Graphical Analytics Dashboard:** Add a visual statistics dashboard using Chart.js or similar library to display bar charts and pie charts of complaint data by category, priority, and month — in addition to the existing tabular reports.
6. **Mobile Application:** Develop a companion Android or iOS application allowing students to submit and track complaints from their smartphones.

7. Complaint Escalation System: Introduce an automatic escalation mechanism — if a complaint remains in 'Pending' status beyond a defined number of days, it is automatically flagged or escalated to a senior admin.
8. Student Feedback and Rating: After a complaint is marked as Resolved, allow students to rate the resolution quality and submit feedback, helping measure admin performance.
9. Full CSV/PDF Export: Extend the existing exportToCSV() JavaScript function (already in main.js) to all complaint tables, and add a server-side PDF export option for the reports page using a library like FPDF or TCPDF.

Chapter 12

CONCLUSION

The College Complaint Management System was developed to address a real and common challenge faced by educational institutions — the lack of a structured, transparent, and traceable mechanism for managing student grievances. The system successfully replaces the informal, paper-based complaint process with a fully functional web-based platform.

The project has been implemented using PHP, MySQL, HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript — all freely available and widely supported technologies. The dual-portal architecture (separate portals for students and administrators), five-table relational database design, priority-based complaint classification, unique complaint number generation, file attachment support, admin response system, and a reports and analytics module collectively make this a complete and practical solution.

From a security perspective, the system implements bcrypt password hashing, session-based authentication, SQL injection prevention through prepared statements, and input sanitization — ensuring that the application is secure for production use.

The project fulfils all stated objectives and provides a solid foundation that can be extended with future enhancements such as email notifications, real-time updates, and department-wise routing. It demonstrates the practical application of web development concepts learned during the BCA program and represents a meaningful contribution to improving academic administration.

REFERENCE

The following resources were referenced during the development and documentation of this project:

1. PHP Manual — Official PHP Documentation. Available at:
<https://www.php.net/manual/en/>
2. MySQL Reference Manual — MySQL 5.7 Documentation. Available at:
<https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/5.7/en/>
3. W3Schools — HTML, CSS, JavaScript Reference and Tutorials.
Available at: <https://www.w3schools.com/>
4. MDN Web Docs — JavaScript Reference. Mozilla Developer Network.
Available at: <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/JavaScript>
5. Font Awesome — Icon Library Documentation. Available at:
<https://fontawesome.com/docs>
6. OWASP Foundation — Web Application Security Guide. Available at:
<https://owasp.org/>
7. PHP: The Right Way — Best Practices for PHP Development. Available
at: <https://phptherightway.com/>
8. Silberschatz, A., Korth, H. F., & Sudarshan, S. — Database System
Concepts, 7th Edition. McGraw-Hill Education.